

Elia Gasparolo
Offerings

The act of offering involves giving; it is a kind of gift extended to a divine being, often accompanied by a plea for help, a supplication, or a wish. The offering does not escape the devotional—it carries a record of the past, a history or story that resides in the depths of the object or ceremony presented as a gesture of gratitude, as an act of submission to another human, an entity, or nature.

Elia Gasparolo has spent years engaging in a manual, artisanal practice, where she becomes one with her surroundings—where plants shelter her, insects speak to her, and scents guide her gaze. With the *Connective Tissues* series, the artist adopts a loving attitude, one marked by patience and respect for materials, using them to create garments, necklaces, and objects that inhabit her. In this process, the scents of fruits take form, dressing bodies, and then returning to Pachamama, where everything ultimately comes to rest. Elia understands this performative act as if she were “watering the soil with the ashes of the husks offered to the fire,” and through that action, the offering becomes a magical wheel of eternal return, a physical manifestation of the transmutation of matter into energy.

Water, earth, air, and fire come together in a dance that unifies and synthesizes all. It is a call from the Essence to return. A return that surrounds us in the fragrances of lindens, lavenders, citruses, and fresh flowers. These aromas envelope us, revealing their beauty, and transforming into beguiling textiles that adorn us and celebrate us, only to later demand the return of what inherently belongs to them. As we, too, belong—ourselves.

Lic. María Carolina Baulo, January 2025